

For the upcoming November 3, 2026 election, voters across Allentown and Lehigh County will decide on **three countywide referendum questions**. These measures propose changes to the Lehigh County Home Rule Charter and appear on every ballot regardless of party registration.

## Lehigh County Ballot Questions (November 2026)

### 1. Election Commission Expansion & Non-Affiliated Representation (Referendum Question 1)

- **The Question:** Amends the county charter to expand the Lehigh County Board of Elections and Registration from **3 to 5 voting members**.
- **The Breakdown:** Currently, the board consists of 3 members. The proposed amendment mandates that the 5-member board consist of **2 Democrats, 2 Republicans, and 1 member from the third-largest political affiliation in the county** (an Independent or unaffiliated registered voter).
- **Why it matters to you:** As an unaffiliated voter, a **YES** vote supports granting non-affiliated/third-party voters a guaranteed seat on the board overseeing county elections and voter registration. A **NO** vote maintains the existing 3-member commission structure.

### 2. County Legal Newspaper Notice Requirements (Referendum Question 2)

- **The Question:** Modifies charter provisions regarding where Lehigh County publishes its official public notices.
- **The Breakdown:** Allows the county to publish official public notices in **at least one newspaper** of general circulation instead of the current requirement to publish in **two separate newspapers**.
- **Why it matters:** A **YES** vote aims to reduce public notice publishing expenses and administrative hurdles given the decline of print newspapers. A **NO** vote keeps the mandate requiring placement in two local newspapers.

### 3. County Retirement Board Membership (Referendum Question 3)

- **The Question:** Changes who represents the Board of Commissioners on the Lehigh County Retirement Board.
- **The Breakdown:** Eliminates the mandatory requirement that the *Chair* of the Board of Commissioners sit on the Retirement Board, allowing Commissioners to designate *any* member of their board to fill that position.
- **Why it matters:** A **YES** vote grants the Board of Commissioners flexibility in delegating pension board responsibilities. A **NO** vote keeps the requirement assigned specifically to the Board Chair.

## How to Review Your Full Ballot

You can review the full text for these measures on [Ballotpedia's Lehigh County Ballot Measures](#) or build a complete sample preview using [BallotReady](#).